

A Choice That Has a Cost: What the Numbers Hide

有代价的选择：数字隐藏了什么

Theme: 心理、决策、责任与人生选择 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The numbers hid a **bitter riddle**: an **impressive** gain that consisted entirely of one good month. “**Therefore** the trend is an **insult** to the reader,” the auditor said. “A **symbolic pat** on the back is not a systematic check, and an **exact** figure can still be a **sour** one.”

The **behavioral** evidence was **audio**, and it was **loud**. “**Consequently**, an **ambition** devoted to a single quarter will **necessarily wander**,” Maya wrote. “The **implement** we need is a **precautionary** one, not a **stylish** one.” **Soon** the council would **knock** and ask for the **perfect** version of the same page.

The **acceptable** range was narrow and the excuse for missing it was not **rational**. “A **dent** in the record is a **clue**, not a crime,” the director said. “Be **straightforward** about the assumption and the reader will forgive the rest.”

The **irrational** part was the **vanity** of the author. “A **juicy** quote and a **silky** paragraph will not make a **dent** disappear,” Lin said. “A **dependable** number is worth more than a **reflective** one, and both are worth more than a **swipe** at the opposition.”

The **resolute** answer was to publish the **desertion** figures alongside the growth figures. “These are the same room and the same simple choice,” the auditor said. “We can suggest that the low quarter was seasonal, and we cannot pretend that it did not occur.”

The **choosy** reader would want the whole series, and the whole series was now required by the term of the contract. The numbers would hide nothing, and the group would have to live with what they showed. **Therefore** the **hard** number arrived **soon**, and it was not **perfect**: the series consisted **necessarily** of one **loud knock** and one quiet **scream**. **Consequently**, we must **wander** through every **acceptable implement** and **comprise** the **exact clue** in the **straightforward** line. A **bitter ambition** devoted to a **rational** story is still **irrational**, and a **pat** on the back is not a **behavioral** finding. The chance to require a better figure is now. A **stylish** and **juicy vanity** is not a **dependable swipe**, and the **excitement** of the entire series must be checked **systematically**. We intend to test the feeling of the reader as well. Whom shall we ask, and whose name stands on the page, and is the number good yet? The reader would seem to want the whole series.

中文翻译

这些数字隐藏了一个苦涩的谜：一个令人印象深刻的增长，完全由一个月的好业绩构成。“因此这个趋势是对读者的侮辱，”审计员说，“一次象征性的拍肩不是一次系统的检查，而一个精确的数字仍然可能是一个酸涩的数字。”

行为层面的证据是音频，而且很响。“因此，献身于单一季度的野心必然会游荡，”曼雅写道，“我们需要的工具是预防性的，而不是时髦的。”很快委员会就会来敲门，索要同一页纸的完美版本。

可接受的范围很窄，而错过它的借口并不合乎理性。“记录上的一处凹痕是一条线索，不是一桩罪，”主管说，“对假设保持直率，读者就会原谅其余的。”

不理性的部分是作者的虚荣。“一句多汁的引语和一段柔滑的段落不会让凹痕消失，”林伟说，“一个可靠的数字比一个沉思的数字更有价值，而两者都比对对手的一次挥击更有价值。”

果断的答案是：把流失的数字与增长的数字放在一起公布。“这些是同一个房间和同一个简单的选择，”审计员说，“我们可以暗示那个低季度是季节性的，却无法假装它没有发生过。”

挑剔的读者会想要整个序列，而整个序列如今是合同条款所要求的。数字将不再隐藏任何东西，而小组必须与它们所显示的东西共处。因此，那个难看的数字很快就来了，而它并不完美：这个序列必然由一声响亮的敲击和一声安静的尖叫组成。结果，我们必须在每一件可接受的工具里游荡，并在那条直白的线上包含那条准确的线索。一份献身于一个理性故事的苦涩野心，仍然是不理性的，而在背上拍一下不是一项行为学发现。要求一个更好数字的机会就在现在。一种时髦而多汁的虚荣不是一次可靠的挥击，而整个序列的兴奋必须被系统地核查。我们打算也测试读者的感受。我们该问谁，而页上放着谁的名字，这个数字现在算好了吗？读者似乎想要整个序列。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
therefore 'ðeəfɔː POS: adv	adv. 因此, 所以 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. (used to introduce a logical conclusion) from that fact or reason or as a result
hard hɑːd POS: a	a. 坚硬的, 硬的, 难的, 艰苦的, 困难的, 坚固的, 猛烈的, 艰难的, 结实的, 确实的; adv. 坚硬地, 努力地, 辛苦地, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. dispassionate; ; a. resisting weight or pressure; s. very strong or vigorous; a. (of light) transmitted direc...
soon suːn POS: adv	adv. 不久, 早, 快, 宁可 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in the near future
perfect 'pɜːfɪkt POS: n	n. 完成时; a. 完美的, 完好的, 理想的, 熟练的, 精确的, 完成式的; vt. 使完美, 修改, 使精通, 改善, 使熟练 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make perfect or complete; a. being complete of its kind and without defect or blemish; s. precisely accurate...
consist kən'sɪst POS: vi	vi. 组成, 存在于, 一致 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. have its essential character; be comprised or contained in; be embodied in; v. be consistent in form, tenor...
necessarily 'nesɪsərɪli POS: adv	adv. 必然地, 必须地, 必要地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in an essential manner; r. as a highly likely consequence
knock nɒk POS: n	n. 敲, 敲打, 敲门; v. 敲击, 互撞, 攻击 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sound of knocking (as on a door or in an engine or bearing); n. negative criticism; n. a vigorous blow; n...
scream skri:m POS: n	n. 尖叫声; vi. 尖叫, 大笑, 尖啸, 令人震惊; vt. 尖叫着说, 大叫大嚷着要求 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. sharp piercing cry; v. make a loud, piercing sound
implement 'ɪmplɪmənt POS: n	n. 工具, 器具, 手段; vt. 实现, 使生效, 执行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. instrumentation (a piece of equipment or tool) used to effect an end; v. apply in a manner consistent with...
acceptable ək'septəbl POS: a	a. 可接受的, 合意的, 可忍受的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. worthy of acceptance or satisfactory; s. judged to be in conformity with approved usage; s. adequate for the...
comprise kəm'praɪz POS: vt	vt. 包含, 构成 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v be composed of; v include or contain; have as a component; v form or compose
impressive ɪm'presɪv POS: a	a. 给人深刻印象的, 威严的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. making a strong or vivid impression; s. producing a strong effect
excitement ɪk'saɪtmənt POS: n	n. 刺激, 兴奋; [医] 兴奋, 激动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being emotionally aroused and worked up
consequently 'kɒnsɪkwəntli POS: adv	adv. 所以 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. (sentence connectors) because of the reason given; r. as a consequence
wander 'wɒndə POS: vi	vi. 游荡, 漫步, 徘徊, 迷路, 离题, 蜿蜒; vt. 在...漫游 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. go via an indirect route or at no set pace
loud laʊd POS: a	a. 大声的, 不断的, 喧闹的; adv. 高声地, 大声地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characterized by or producing sound of great volume or intensity
bitter 'bɪtə POS: a	a. 苦的, 痛苦的, 怀恨的; adv. 刺痛; v. (使)变苦 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. English term for a dry sharp-tasting ale with strong flavor of hops (usually on draft); n. the taste experi...
ambition æm'bɪʃən POS: n	n. 野心, 志向 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a cherished desire; n. a strong drive for success; v. have as one's ambition
devote dɪ'vəʊt POS: vt	vt. 投入于, 献身 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. set aside or apart for a specific purpose or use
rational 'ræʃənəl POS: a	a. 理性的, 合理的; n. 有理数 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. consistent with or based on or using reason; a. capable of being expressed as a quotient of integers; s. hav...
exact ɪg'zækt POS: a	a. 精确的, 准确的, 精密的; vt. 强求, 急需 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. marked by strict and particular and complete accordance with fact
clue kluː POS: n	n. 线索, 暗示; vt. 暗示, 提供线索 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. evidence that helps to solve a problem; v. roll into a ball

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
straightforward streɪt'fɔ:wəd POS: a	a. 笔直的, 率直的, 明确的, 简单的, 直接的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. free from ambiguity; s. pointed directly ahead
behavioral bi'heɪvjərəl POS: a	a. 行为的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to behavior
pat pæt POS: n	n. 轻拍; v. 轻拍; adv. 适时, 正好, 恰好, 毫不迟疑, 熟记地; a. 恰好的, 合适的, 熟练的, 坚定的, 人为的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sound made by a gentle blow; s. exactly suited to the occasion; r. completely or perfectly
symbolic sɪm'bɒlɪk POS: a	a. 象征的, 符号的; [电] 符号化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or using or proceeding by means of symbols; a. using symbolism
sour 'sauə POS: a	a. 酸的, 酸臭的, 发酵的, 恼怒的, 讨厌的, 拙劣的, 不健全的; vi. 变酸, 发酵, 厌烦, 变坏; vt. 使变酸, 使失望; ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a cocktail made of a liquor (especially whiskey or gin) mixed with lemon or lime juice and sugar; n. the ta...
audio 'ɔ:diu POS: a	a. 音频的, 声音的; [电] 声频 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the audible part of a transmitted signal; n. an audible acoustic wave frequency; n. the sound elements of te...
insult 'ɪnsʌlt POS: n	n. 侮辱, 无礼, 损害; vt. 损害, 侮辱, 攻击 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a deliberately offensive act or something producing the effect of deliberate disrespect
reflective rɪ'flektɪv POS: a	a. 反射的, 反映的, 沉思的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. capable of physically reflecting light or sound; s. devoted to matters of the mind
systematically 'sɪstɪ'mætɪkli POS: adv	adv. 有系统地, 有组织地, 有条理地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in a systematic or consistent manner
irrational 'ɪræʃənəl POS: n	n. 无理数; a. 无理性的, 不合理的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not consistent with or using reason; a. real but not expressible as the quotient of two integers
stylish 'stɑɪlɪʃ POS: a	a. 现代风格的, 流行的, 潇洒的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having elegance or taste or refinement in manners or dress
juicy 'dʒʊsi POS: a	a. 多汁液的, 生动的, 多水分的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. full of juice; s. having strong sexual appeal
vanity 'vænɪti POS: n	n. 虚荣心, 虚无, 自负, 空虚, 时髦的小摆饰 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being valueless or futile
dent dent POS: n	n. 凹痕; vt. 使凹下, 削弱; vi. 塌陷 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an appreciable consequence (especially a lessening); n. an impression in a surface (as made by a blow)
riddle 'rɪdl POS: n	n. 谜, 谜语, 粗筛; vt. 解谜, 给...出谜, 筛, 寻根究底地检验, 充满于; vi. 出谜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a difficult problem; n. a coarse sieve (as for gravel); v. pierce with many holes; v. set a difficult problem...
silky 'sɪlki POS: a	a. 丝的, 柔滑的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. having a smooth, gleaming surface reflecting light
dependable dɪ'pendəbl POS: a	a. 可信任的, 可靠的, 可信赖的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. worthy of being depended on; s. consistent in performance or behavior; s. financially sound
swipe swaɪp POS: n	n. 强打, 用力挥击, 尖刻的话, 碰擦, 起重杆; vt. 强打, 用力挥击, 偷 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sweeping stroke or blow; v. strike with a swiping motion
resolute 'rezəlu:t POS: n	n. 果断的人; a. 坚决的, 刚毅的, 毅然决然的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. firm in purpose or belief; characterized by firmness and determination
desertion dɪ'zə:ʃən POS: n	n. 丢掉, 遗弃, 逃亡; [法] 长期分居, 开小差, 遗弃 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. withdrawing support or help despite allegiance or responsibility
precautionary prɪ'kɔ:ʃənəri POS: a	a. 预先警戒的, 预防的, 留心的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. taken in advance to protect against possible danger or failure
choosy 'tʃu:zi POS: a	a. 慎重选择的, 好挑剔的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. difficult to please